

Dolly Yu

Yale University, School of Management
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EDUCATION

Yale University, School of Management

Expected May 2027

PhD Candidate in Financial Economics.

Committee: James Choi (Chair), Boris Vallée, Paul Goldsmith-Pinkham, Andrew Metrick, David Argente

Yale University

May 2019

Master of Arts in International and Development Economics, High Distinction.

University of Toronto, St. George Campus

June 2018

Honours Bachelor of Science in Economics and Statistics, CGPA: 3.90/4.00.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Household Finance, Financial Innovation, Financial Intermediation

WORKING PAPERS

“The Shadow Cost of Credit Utilization: Payment Choice and Liquidity Management” (Job Market Paper)

with Jose Murillo (Primerio AI)

We study the effect of a household's credit capacity on its preference for credit versus cash payments. Linking 1.5 million consumption records to each household's real-time credit position, we observe that as a household's credit utilization increases, it tends to use more cash, demonstrating a convex pattern. This convexity is consistent with a precautionary mechanism: the marginal value of available credit increases as capacity shrinks, resulting in a convex rise in the cost of credit for all households. Households carrying a balance incur additional interest costs and consequently use cash more frequently at every utilization level. Bank-initiated credit limit increases, which expand available credit without affecting the balance, causally decrease cash usage. Inverting the cash shares yields a monetary estimate of the cost: an additional dollar of credit incurs an average cost of 28 cents, with half of this cost attributed to the precautionary channel. Consequently, payment choice, when analyzed alongside the credit position at the transaction level, provides a direct measure of the shadow cost of drawing down borrowing capacity.

“Fintech to the (Worker) Rescue? Earned Wage Access, Worker Welfare and Employee Retention” [\[SSRN\]](#)

with Jose Murillo (Primerio AI) and Boris Vallée (INSEAD)

We study the usage and welfare implications of earned wage access (EWA) using administrative and survey data from a Mexican FinTech provider. Adoption is significant, and usage concentrates at the end of the pay cycle. We develop a stationary buffer-stock framework, calibrated to the data, in which EWA provides liquidity insurance and consumption-timing alignment. Access is worth about 2.5% of a paycheck per year for the average user, and an order of magnitude more for impatient, low-liquidity workers. Automatic repayment makes these gains more robust to present bias than with revolving credit. EWA usage is associated with higher employee retention, as the framework implies.

“Riding the Waves: Geographic Diversification and Bank Responses to Local Funding Shocks”

with Wei Li (UIBE) and Mingmei Liu (JNU)

Best Paper Award, The 8th Asia Conference on Business and Economic Studies, 2026

How resilient are banks to local funding shocks? We exploit a segment of Chinese wealth management products (WMPs) funded locally but backed by national assets, allowing us to isolate banks' strategic responses to local funding pressures. Using city-level inflation to characterize investor demand shifts, we find that banks pass through approximately 60% of these shocks to WMP yields. Large, geographically diversified banks respond more actively, by raising yields and contracting issuance in shock-hit markets more sharply than smaller banks. They then hedge by expanding the issuance of lower-yield WMPs in unaffected regions. Our findings reveal that for large banks, geographic diversification is not a tool for passive insulation but a mechanism enabling active, high-frequency liability management through their internal capital markets.

WORK IN PROGRESS

“The Economics of Rent-to-Own Housing”

Documents product features and usage patterns of rent-to-own customers utilizing proprietary company data, and evaluates the optimality conditions for using rent-to-own contracts by calibrating a housing choice model.

“Mortgage Securitization and Housing Affordability”

with Daojing Zhai (Baruch)

Establishes the link between the rise of institutional investors in the single-family rental market and the small-dollar mortgage shortage, and discusses the falling convenience premium of private securitization as a channel in the post-crisis era.

OTHER WRITING

“A Case in Point: Shared Home Equity” [\[HBS Publishing\]](#)

with Boris Vallée, Daniel Green, and Sid Beaumaster (all HBS). Harvard Business School Case 221-026

“Seso Global: Building a Blockchain-enabled Property Marketplace in Nigeria” [\[HBS Publishing\]](#)

with Boris Vallée (HBS). Harvard Business School Case 220-055

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2026

Asian Meeting of the Econometric Society*

The 8th Asia Conference on Business and Economic Studies*

Peking University FinTech Workshop*

SGF Conference

Midwest Finance Association (MFA)

Yale Finance Lunch

2025

Paris December Finance Meeting*

European Winter Meeting of the Econometric Society (EWMES)*

Sydney Banking and Financial Stability Conference*

Yale Finance Lunch (x2)

2024

Yale Finance Lunch (x2)

2023

NBER Innovative Data in Household Finance

Yale Finance Lunch (x2)

2021

HBS Brownbag*

** Presented by co-author*

HONORS AND AWARDS

PhD Fellowship, Yale University	2021 – present
Best Paper Award, The 8th Asia Conference on Business and Economic Studies	2026
New College Council In-Course Scholarship, University of Toronto	2016
Dean's List Scholar, University of Toronto	2015, 2016, 2018

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Fellow, Yale University

- Household Finance (PhD)
- Personal Finance (MBA)
- Fixed Income Securities I (MBA)
- Capital Markets (MBA)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Associate, Harvard Business School

July 2019 – June 2021

to Professor Boris Vallée and Jonas Heese

Selected Research Acknowledgements:

“Can Security Design Foster Household Risk-Taking?” (Journal of Finance, 2023)

“FinTech Lending and Cashless Payments” (Journal of Finance, 2026)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Summer Intern, Chang'an International Trust, Qingdao, China

May 2016 – July 2016

UNIVERSITY AND COMMUNITY SERVICE

Mentor, Economic Students' Association Mentorship Program

September 2017 – May 2018

REFERENCES AND DISSERTATION COMMITTEE

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